01 / START WITH A HUMAN

Your AI built it. Would you trust it?

A design-and-testing lab for the personal portfolio you created through vibe coding.

THE MISSION By the end, your portfolio should feel like a real person made deliberate choices: clear, credible, usable, and easy to update. You are the reviewer; AI is your collaborator.

YOUR NAME / BATCH	YOUR PORTFOLIO URL
_____	_____

LAB ROUTE · 10 min first impression / 15 min design audit / 20 min real-world tests / 25 min improve + review

01 The 10-second visitor test

No explanations allowed

Show your home page to a partner for exactly 10 seconds. Hide it. Ask them the following questions without giving hints:

ASK YOUR PARTNER	THEIR ANSWER
Whose website was that?	_____
What does this person study, make, or care about?	_____
What would you click first?	_____

What did they misunderstand or fail to notice?

02 Decide who the site is for

Choose one primary audience

[ ] A senior student or mentor [ ] A recruiter [ ] A professor [ ] A collaborator [ ] Someone else: _____

What should that visitor understand or do in the first 15 seconds?

03 Freeze version 1

Before asking AI to improve anything

- Save a screenshot or a copy of your current site. You will compare it with your final version.
- Write the first impression in three words: _____ _____ _____

DISCUSS If every student used the same AI tool and prompt, why might all the portfolios look alike? What would make yours recognisably yours?

02 / LOOK WITH INTENT

Does it look professional?

For every question, inspect your own website. Mark P = pass, ~ = needs work, X = broken. Record evidence, not guesses.

04 Identity & credibility

LOOK FOR THIS	P / ~ / X	EVIDENCE OR FIX
In 5 seconds, can I tell your name and what you actually do or study?	___	_____
Does the About section sound like you, not a generic AI-generated biography?	___	_____
Are all achievements, skills, awards, statistics, and job titles truthful?	___	_____
Does each listed project explain the problem and what YOU did?	___	_____

05 Visual choices

LOOK FOR THIS	P / ~ / X	EVIDENCE OR FIX
Are emojis absent or used deliberately, rather than decorating every line?	___	_____
Are colors restrained and consistent, with readable text contrast?	___	_____
Do fonts, headings, buttons, and spacing follow a clear pattern?	___	_____
Is there breathing room, or is every area filled with cards/effects?	___	_____
Do images or animations support the content rather than distract?	___	_____

06 Visitor journey

LOOK FOR THIS	P / ~ / X	EVIDENCE OR FIX
Can I find projects, skills, and contact details without hunting?	___	_____
Do section names, buttons, and navigation labels say what they do?	___	_____
Are there NO template leftovers, fake testimonials, or placeholder links?	___	_____
Does the first screen show the most important message and next action?	___	_____

Pick the TWO issues that would most damage a stranger's trust. Why those?

YOUR CHOICE MATTERS An emoji is not automatically unprofessional, and dark themes are not automatically better. Judge each design choice by audience, clarity, and purpose.

03 / TEST THE PROMISES

Does it actually work?

A polished screenshot is not enough. Pretend you are a visitor with a different device, limited time, and no knowledge of the code.

07 The no-HTML editing challenge

Use AI, but do not hand-edit the HTML file

Ask your AI coding assistant to help you make content easy to maintain. Then TRY these actions using an on-page editor or another simple content-editing method:

CHALLENGE	WHAT REALLY HAPPENED?
A. Change one sentence in your About section.	[ ] Worked [ ] Needed a change [ ] Could not do it
B. Add one REAL project with a title, description and link or "in progress" label.	[ ] Worked [ ] Needed a change [ ] Could not do it
C. Edit or remove that project without changing HTML.	[ ] Worked [ ] Needed a change [ ] Could not do it

Do not invent impressive projects. A small class assignment is more credible than a fictional startup.

08 Where did the change go?

Investigate before believing AI

CHECK AFTER ADDING YOUR PROJECT	VISIBLE?
Reload the same page in the same browser.	Yes / No / Not tested
Open the published site in a private/incognito window.	Yes / No / Not tested
Ask a friend to open it on their device.	Yes / No / Not tested

What do these results tell you about where the information is stored?

REALITY CHECK Some AI-built editors save only in your browser (for example, localStorage). This does NOT automatically update the published site for everyone. A real shared editing system is an optional stretch goal.

09 Try to break it

Have your partner perform these tests

REAL-WORLD TEST	PASS / FAIL + EVIDENCE
Narrow your browser to phone width. Any clipped text or sideways scrolling?	_____
Open every project, social, contact and navigation link. Real destination?	_____
Use only Tab and Enter. Can you reach and activate main links?	_____
Can you read the text comfortably and tell what is clickable?	_____
Do you expose private phone, address, passwords or personal data?	_____

04 / IMPROVE AND PROVE

Make the second version earn its place.

AI can suggest a fix. You decide whether the fix worked. Complete at least two meaningful iterations.

10 Prompt like a designer

Give evidence and a test, not just "make it better"

PROMPT FRAME "A [type of visitor] tried to [task] but [specific problem]. Change [part of site] so that [observable outcome]. Keep [what already works]. Do not invent facts about me. Tell me how I can test the result."

Example: "On a phone, the project cards extend off-screen. Make them fit without horizontal scrolling, but keep the current content. Show me how to check it."

11 The improvement log

What changed and how do you know?

ITERATION	PROBLEM OBSERVED	PROMPT / CHANGE MADE	TEST RESULT
1	_____ _____	_____ _____	_____
2	_____ _____	_____ _____	_____

12 Peer review

Trade devices, not compliments

My partner could immediately understand:

One thing that still felt confusing, generic or untrustworthy:

One improvement I accepted OR rejected from the AI, and why:

13 The release gate

Check before calling it finished

[ ] My identity and claims are accurate. [ ] No placeholder text or dead links. [ ] At least one genuine project or learning experience.

[ ] Contact method works and respects my privacy. [ ] Readable on a phone. [ ] Visual choices feel intentional.

[ ] I tested, rather than trusted, the AI's changes. [ ] I can explain how content is updated and what its limitations are.

Final published link (or local demo location):

Exit ticket: What is ONE thing that made your portfolio professional that AI did not decide for you?

OPTIONAL STRETCH · Build a safe, authenticated way to update published content across devices, or perform an accessibility check with a screen reader. Be ready to demonstrate—not just describe—it.